Phase 0: Triage Verdict Summary

CAGE-Fake Final Decision & Policy Arbitration

Title: Man gets life term for abducting, raping minor
Source URL: https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/city/agra/man-gets-life-term-for-abducting-raping-minor/articleshow/135241727.cms
Word Count: 215 words | **Date:** 2026-10-28 22:10:23

VERDICT: UNCERTAIN

Confidence: 50.0% | **Gating Trigger:** style_lexical_split
Policy Category: Abstain (Stylometric vs Lexical Split)
Explanation: Base models split on verdict with stylometric RF expert dissenting (RF P(FAKE)=42.1%, but LR=69.5%, LGBM=91.1%, XGB=93.9%). Lexical and semantic models key on out-of-domain vocabulary while stylometric expert dissents.

Phase 1: Claim-Level Evidence Grounding

Extracted Factual Assertions & Authoritative Corroboration

Claim	Status	Source	Evidence Context
Agra: A special Pocso court in Agra has sentenced a 30-year-old man to life imprisonment on Tuesday for sexually assault	Unverified	No live sources >= 0.60 similarity	No corroborating external sources met the >= 0.60 semantic similarity floor.
During the trial, the prosecution examined 12 witnesses, including the complainant, the minor survivor, two doctors, ACP	Supported	medicaldialogues.in	“During the trial, the court examined 12 prosecution witnesses, of whom six, including the complainant, turned hostile.
While delivering the verdict, special judge (Pocso) Sonika Chaudhary highlighted society’s failure to protect girls desp	Supported	hindustantimes.com	![The special judge (POCSO Court), Sonika Chaudhary, observed that although young girls are considered ‘devi’ in Indian society, society has failed to
Man gets life term for abducting, raping minor.	Supported	abc3340.com	# Life behind bars for man convicted of kidnapping and raping 10-year-old The Blount County man convicted of kidnapping and raping a 10-year-old girl

Phase 2: Entity & Numerical Consistency

Symbolic Comparison of Cardinal Figures, Dates, and Named Entities

Numeric Conflicts Detected: None
Corroborated Trusted Domains: hindustantimes.com
Cross-Consistency Summary: 1/4 claims supported across 1 trusted domains.

Phase 3: Lexical Expert Diagnosis

Sparse Vocabulary Distribution & Linear Feature Coefficients

Model: Logistic Regression on Raw Sparse TF-IDF (No SVD)
P(FAKE): 69.5%
Top Driving Tokens:

Phase 4: Style Expert Diagnosis

Tree-Based Stylometric & Readability Analysis with SHAP TreeExplainer

Model: XGBoost on 19 Named Stylometric Features
P(FAKE): 42.1%
Top SHAP Impact Features:

Phase 5: Semantic Expert Diagnosis

Deep Contextual Representation & Gradient-Based Token Highlights

Model: Fine-Tuned DistilRoBERTa / MuRIL Transformer
P(FAKE): 93.9%
Token Attributions (Integrated Gradients):

Phase 6: Evidence Verification Metrics

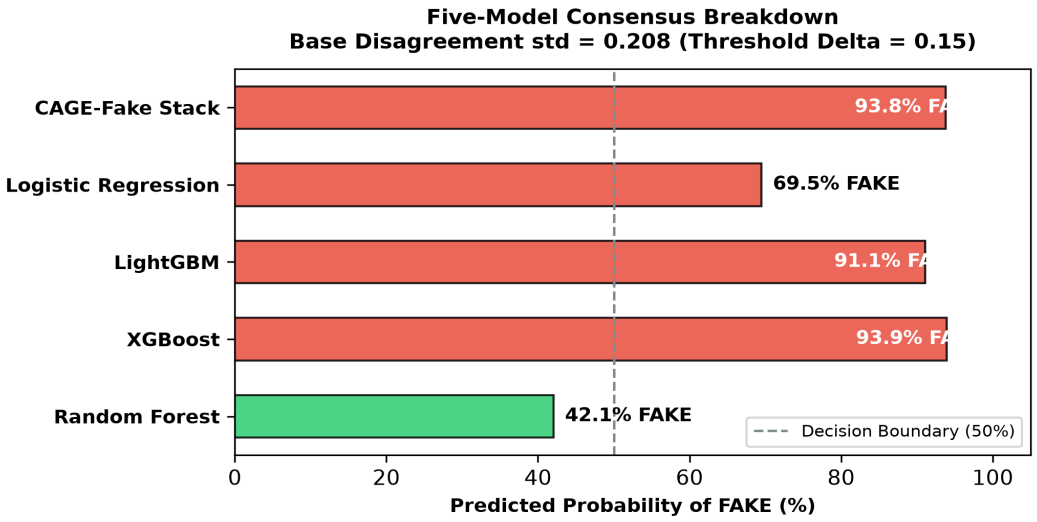
Authoritative Whitelist Verification & External Truth Grounding

Total Claims Evaluated: 4
Supported Claims: 3 (25.0%)
Contradicted Claims: 0
Unverified Claims: 1
Independent Trusted Domains: 1

Phase 7: Multi-View Consensus Meter

Inter-Expert Disagreement & Variance Decomposition

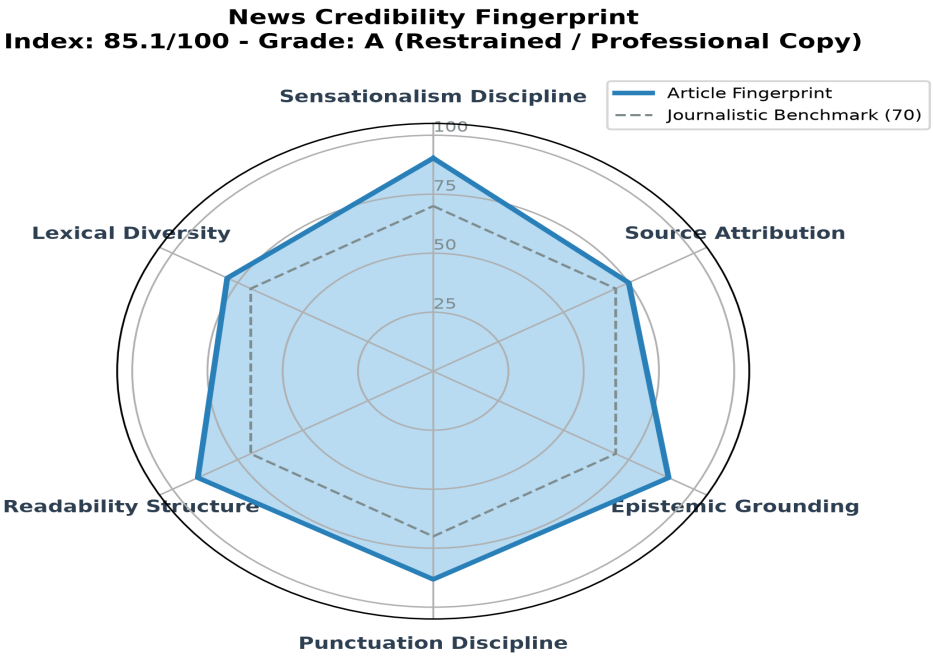
Multi-View Disagreement (delta_views = std): 0.2079
Mean Multi-View P(FAKE): 93.8%
Lexical P(FAKE): 69.5%
Style P(FAKE): 42.1%
Semantic P(FAKE): 93.9%



Phase 8: News Credibility Fingerprint

Stylistic & Journalistic Norm Scorecard

Overall Credibility Index: 85.1 / 100
Credibility Tier: A (Restrained / Professional Copy)



Phase 9: Tri-Trigger Gate Arbitration

Confidence (tau), Multi-View Disagreement (delta), and Domain Shift (rho)

Tri-Trigger Gate Evaluation:

- Confidence Threshold tau: 80.0%
- View Disagreement Threshold delta: 0.15
- Domain Shift Threshold rho: 0.56
- Trigger Result: **style_lexical_split**
- Decision Output: **UNCERTAIN**

Phase 10: Out-Of-Distribution Domain Shift Check

Lexical Vocabulary Coverage & Semantic Mahalanobis Distance

OOD Status: IN-DISTRIBUTION
Composite OOD Score: 0.4695 (Threshold rho = 0.5600)
TF-IDF Vocabulary Coverage: 80.0%
SBERT Mahalanobis Distance: 19.95
Diagnostic Note: High semantic embedding distance (20.0 vs mean 17.2)